

Chapter 34-11

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In the evening, Sally and Cherry stayed at her house for dinner. Sally insisted on drinking that bottle of wine and asked Liang Shi to make drinking snacks for her.

Halfway through the meal, Sun Meirou came over. They originally wanted her to stay for dinner, but the old mansion was still waiting for them to return home before eating, so she left with Ling Dang.

Ling Dang said reluctantly: "Auntie, can I come play with you again next week?"

Liang Shi immediately agreed.

It had to be said that when the originally chattering little child suddenly left, it made people feel somewhat unaccustomed.

After three rounds of drinks, Liang Shi's face was red again, and Sally only looked sober. She smiled teasingly: "Liang Shi, your alcohol tolerance is no good."

Liang Shi refused to admit defeat: "You can say I'm no good at other things, but not alcohol tolerance."

Sally suddenly smiled ambiguously: "What other aspects are you no good at?"

Liang Shi: "..."

She smiled and didn't respond further.

"Initially I thought you were terrible," Sally said. "Cherry told me not to have any expectations of you, but I didn't expect that after meeting you, the more I spent time with you, the more I liked you. You're such a warm person, always smiling at everyone. It's comfortable."

Liang Shi chuckled lightly: "What, should I be crying instead?"

"You can do everything, treasure girl!" Sally put her arm around her shoulders, making Lin Luoxi hold her forehead and say coldly: "If you're drunk, go home and wash up and sleep. Don't talk nonsense here."

She even betrayed her!

This woman really deserved a good beating.

Sally remained unmoved and instead glanced at her sideways: "Let me tell you, Cherry, after being away from here for so many years, what I missed most wasn't the food, but you! I'm so unsatisfied! How can I love you so much?!"

Lin Luoxi rolled her eyes: "Should I praise your great love that you can abandon at any time?"

Sally: "..."

As they chatted back and forth, Xu Qingzhu sat nearby holding her wine glass and watching. Suddenly her phone rang.

She looked at the caller ID—it was Bai Weiwei!

She immediately answered, her voice indescribably light and cheerful. At least Bai Weiwei was willing to contact her. "Weiwei."

"Xu Qingzhu, what do you mean?" Bai Weiwei's opening was accusatory. "Liang Shi hasn't even entered the industry yet and you're buying her trending topics to overshadow Chen Liuying¹. What did Chen Liuying do to offend you? Oh right, it's me who offended you, isn't it?"

Xu Qingzhu looked confused: "What do you mean? When did Liang Shi want to enter the industry?"

"Still pretending?" Bai Weiwei's voice carried a sob but showed more anger. "Can you stop pretending? Acting high and mighty all the time, is that great? To make Liang Shi quickly become famous, you directly stepped on Chen Liuying to get ahead? I'm not dead yet."

"No, Weiwei, what do you mean exactly? What trending topic did I buy?"

"Go look for yourself." Bai Weiwei was so angry she cursed: "Really disgusting."

She hung up after saying that.

The originally good mood was completely ruined by this scolding phone call.

After being hung up on, Xu Qingzhu immediately opened Weibo and saw that the top trending topic was #Even a Random Dog from the Street Would Act Better Than Chen Liuying#.

Bai Weiwei had spoken so loudly that Lin Luoxi heard too and also opened the trending topics.

Both frowned as they clicked into that topic. Below was a short video of Liang Shi and Chen Liuying acting together. Originally, when watching on site, the gap wasn't so striking, but through the camera comparison, Liang Shi's acting was indeed much better than Chen Liuying's. After all, Liang Shi's sense for finding the camera was much stronger than Chen Liuying's.

The blogger's caption read: [The topic is indeed somewhat exaggerated, but that day they really did randomly pull someone from the street to act. The previous actress quit, and this young lady substituted and was unexpectedly good. Facts prove that Chen Liuying's acting really is terrible.]

After reading it, Xu Qingzhu felt mixed emotions.

She wasn't crazy enough to buy this kind of trending topic. For a moment, she couldn't tell if this topic was insulting Chen Liuying or insulting Liang Shi.

After Lin Luoxi finished reading, she was speechless: "What's wrong with Bai Weiwei? Acting like a mad dog, biting randomly. For her girlfriend with a phoenix face² who can't be helped no matter how much support she gets?"

Xu Qingzhu felt down: "I don't know."

"She already fell out with me because of Chen Liuying before, and now she's falling out with you too?" Lin Luoxi asked.

"Ah?" Xu Qingzhu was hearing about this for the first time.

Lin Luoxi explained the whole story.

Because Lin Luoxi's aunt's family had a relatively popular fashion brand, they were looking for a new spokesperson at the time. Chen Liuying and another female artist were competing. Their company had always favored using talented actors, so they decisively chose the other female artist. The contract process was already underway, just not yet announced publicly, but Bai Weiwei came to Lin Luoxi asking for Chen Liuying.

Lin Luoxi had always maintained a business-is-business approach, so she politely declined.

Unexpectedly, Bai Weiwei talked behind her back, and when Lin Luoxi heard about it, they had a fight and eventually fell out.

Finally, Lin Luoxi concluded: "Chen Liuying is just a parasite sucking blood while clinging to Bai Weiwei. But since Bai Weiwei accepts it willingly, then respect and bless them—lock it down."

Xu Qingzhu sighed: "I don't understand why this is happening. We used to be so close."

"Wasn't the incident she was exposed for last time related to you?" Lin Luoxi said. "The Huayue International one."

Xu Qingzhu nodded.

"You came out of it unscathed, while she almost got broken up with, ruined, and even attempted suicide in anger." Lin Luoxi sneered coldly. "She's jealous of you."

"How could that be?" Xu Qingzhu was astonished. "I..."

"Enough, don't mention your college days." Lin Luoxi said. "There's a type of person who hopes her friends do well, but not better than herself. So when you were at similar levels before, you could be friends, but now that the gap has widened, her malice is sharper than knives."

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Xu Qingzhu didn't rest well all night because of this incident.

She tossed and turned thinking about Lin Luoxi's words, and kept checking her phone and Weibo. The trending topic was dropping at a rapid pace.

Meanwhile, Liang Shi was somewhat dizzy from drinking that night. Looking at the trending topic, she just said: "Her acting really is terrible."

This left Xu Qingzhu completely speechless.

The next morning, Xu Qingzhu hastily ate a bit of breakfast, and before Liang Shi even woke up, she had already driven to the company.

She arrived relatively early, made a cup of coffee, and then began working.

At eleven in the morning, the design department head went out for a while. When he returned, he asked everyone to stop their current work, saying there would be a meeting to introduce a new colleague.

Everyone was talking among themselves.

"What new colleague needs such a big ceremony?"

"RT's Annual Emerging Designer. Don't know where our boss invited them from."

"Having to hold a special meeting for her when everyone has a pile of work to do."

"..."

But they still listened to the department head and obediently gathered in the conference room.

Xu Qingzhu sat in the deputy's position, still holding her notebook checking proposals. After a while, the department head pushed open the door: "Alright, everyone, sorry for the wait. Our new colleague just got lost. Now let's welcome our new colleague."

Everyone looked expectantly toward the door, and even Xu Qingzhu stopped her work to look up and see who this divine being was.

A woman in a black suit entered, with an evil smile at the corner of her mouth. Her black leather shoes clicked all the way to the middle of the conference room. Her voice was light and airy, yet incredibly confident: "Hello everyone, I am—Zhou Yi'an."

Footnotes:

¹ **Chen Liuying (陈流荧)**: A character mentioned as an actress with poor acting skills, described as Bai Weiwei's girlfriend.

² **Phoenix face (凤凰脸)**: A Chinese expression referring to someone with striking, noble-looking features but here used somewhat sarcastically to indicate that despite having good looks, the person lacks talent.